



# Delaware County Council Meeting September 27th 2022

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dyo6fSalpYQ">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dyo6fSalpYQ</a> |
| Publication Date | 2022-09-27T14:54:15Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** September 27, 2022

**Location:** Delaware County Commissioners Courtroom

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

*No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting.*

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at 9:00 AM by the presiding officer in the Delaware County Commissioners Courtroom.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, and Commissioner Shannon Henry.
  - **Absent:** Mr. Freeman (excused due to a family/child illness).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Council President / Presiding Officer (unnamed explicitly in the opening).

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Commissioner Shannon Henry led the room in the Pledge of Allegiance. A moment of silence was held in remembrance of past Commissioner Don Dunnick.
  - **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved with a modification moving the resolution to follow the financial transfers, upon a motion by Ms. Piper, seconded by Ms. Lassiter, and approved by a roll call vote (7-0).
  - **Approval of Minutes:** August meeting minutes were approved upon a motion by Ms. Piper, seconded by Mr. Quakenbush, and approved by a roll call vote (7-0).
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### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:56 Presentation: Guardian Advocates Incorporated**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator), John Longacre (Attorney/Madison County Chapter Director), and Linda Johnson (Development Coordinator).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters outlined the Guardian Advocates program (a VASIA/probate code 29 program), which matches trained volunteers with incapacitated adults, elderly individuals, and nursing home residents who lack family or have suffered financial exploitation/neglect. The program expanded into Delaware County in fall 2021 and is merging with "Area Five" to cover eight counties total. Commissioners previously pledged \$10,000 for this year and next year; the organization is requesting council support and local matching funds to leverage Indiana Supreme Court grants (2-to-1 match).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board action required at this time.
- **00:21:25 Letter of Support: Indiana Michigan Power (Middle Mile Grant Application)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Dr. Rob Keesling.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of a request from Dr. Rob Keesling for the council's blessing to send a letter of support for Indiana Michigan Power's middle mile broadband grant application.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:22:51 Ordinance Introduction: Part-Time Salaries (Ordinance 2022-016)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Ben (HR).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding part-time salary ordinance formatting. It was agreed that the ordinance number is 2022-016 (updated from 2018), and staff will work with HR to present it properly for formal introduction next month. No motion necessary at this stage.
- **00:24:55 Financial Transfers & Addendums**

- **Circuit Court (County General):** Transfer of \$1,802.22 to cover unpaid bills for panic button upgrades/analog-to-digital conversion. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **Communications:** Internal line-item transfers totaling zero for training, overtime, maintenance supplies, professional cleaning, utilities, and dues/subscriptions. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **EMS:** Transfer of \$8,494.92 (adjusted from initial figures) from paramedic accounts. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **Ball Brothers Grant (High-Tech Crimes Unit):** Transfer of \$5,474.50 into training from forensic software and computer lines. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **Statewide 911 (Fund 1222):** Transfer of \$8,000 from CAD coordinator to overtime. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **Bridge (Fund 1135) & Highway Department (Fund 1176):** Payroll clerk and truck driver line-item transfers reflecting staffing changes and resignations. *(Approved by roll call votes, 7-0).*
- **Addendum Transfers (Commissioners, EMS, Circuit Court, Communications):** Additional adjustments including commissioners moving funds for PERS, health insurance, and utilities (\$180,000); EMS adjustments; Circuit Court web maintenance (\$2,500); and Communications copier/equipment funds. *(All approved by roll call votes, 7-0).*
- **00:43:31 Additional Appropriations: Sheriff's Department**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Office representative.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$363 from the drug task unit / seizure fund to replace/repair security locking systems (fob system) at the office.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:45:36 Additional Appropriations: American Rescue Plan (ARP) Funds**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shannon / Jenny (Commissioners' Office).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of ARP fund appropriations totaling \$8,340,724 across multiple infrastructure and community projects:
    - Yorktown water/sewer project (State Road 332 bore): \$1,000,000
    - Delaware County Fire Departments (911 upgrade/iPads/licenses): \$50,000
    - Administrative fees (up to 10%): \$2,000,000
    - Community Corrections (DCCC - educational/domestic violence programs): \$100,000
    - Salem Township (Overlooked Drive wastewater/lift station): \$500,000
    - Westdale School (water/sewage line from Gaston): \$500,000
    - County housing development infrastructure (67/Daleville Road area, ~49-80 acres): \$2,500,000
    - Shell building infrastructure (4-acre lot near I-69): \$270,000
    - Broadband expansion: \$1,420,724

- *Discussion:* Extensive debate occurred regarding the housing infrastructure appropriation. Member Ron expressed opposition to using government funds for private subdivision infrastructure, noting historical context where local developers bore those costs entirely. Proponents emphasized housing shortages tied to incoming industrial jobs and economic development incentives.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 6-1 (Member Ron voted "No").
- **00:00:00 Additional Appropriations: Miscellaneous Funds**
  - **Elected Official Training (Fund 1217):** \$2,000 for auditor schooling. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
  - **EMS Overtime Replacement (Fund 4930):** \$12,500 for overtime. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
  - **EMS Capital Improvements (Fund 4910):** \$128,289 for ambulance rechassis (reusing aluminum boxes due to high aluminum costs). *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
  - **Public Defender Supplemental (Fund 1200):** \$52,500 (\$3,000 bonuses for public defenders handling COVID case backlogs; 40% state reimbursable). *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
  - **Supreme Court Grant (Fund 8108):** \$11,600 for travel/training, incentives, and drug screens, backed by a recent revenue deposit. *(Approved by roll call vote, 7-0).*
- **01:29:59 Resolution to Reduce 2022 Budget**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Ben.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on moving Resolution 2022-016 (budget reduction resolution) to the upcoming budget hearings session to be handled properly via Gateway.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to move the resolution to the budget hearing passed by roll call vote (7-0).

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:31:01 Justin Curley (Purdue Extension):** Introduced himself as the interim county extension director and agriculture and natural resources educator while the county searches for a permanent replacement for Lauren.
  - **01:31:51 Jane (Council Member / AIC Report):** Provided a brief update on the Association of Indiana Counties (AIC) conference and noted she will bring forward legislative considerations next month.
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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Council recessed briefly before reconvening at approximately 10:45 AM for scheduled budget sessions.
- **Adjournment:** The regular meeting was adjourned upon a motion by Mr. Ballard, seconded by Ms. Piper, and approved by roll call vote (7-0).

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